CRITTER CAPTURE

Game Overview

WHAT IT IS

Critter Capture is a monster-catching role-playing game in the classic Game Boy tradition, rebuilt to a modern standard. You walk a region on foot, meet wild creatures in the tall grass, battle them in turn-based fights, and catch them to build a team. It runs in a web browser, so it plays on a tablet and inside a Meta Quest 3 headset, with nothing to install.

The aim is not to out-size the games that inspired it. It is to be distinctive and premium: a tight, dense adventure that feels like a remake rather than a throwback to one.

THE WORLD

The region is Rivenmoor. The journey runs in one long line that keeps opening: a coastal home village, three towns in a wooded valley, a lake crossing, a mining town, a mountain pass, a coastal city, and finally the league tower.

Each leg is gated by a badge or a field power, so progress is also permission. You can see where you are not yet allowed to go, which is what makes exploring feel like achievement.

Roughly twenty areas: six towns, crossing routes, two forests, two cave systems, a coast and a sea route, a mountain, a marsh, ruins, and the league approach. Time of day shifts the colour of the world and changes what appears in the grass - some creatures come out only at night, others only in rain.

THE CREATURES

Thirty-six species ship in the first chapter. They are built as data rather than code, so the roster can grow past a hundred later by adding entries rather than features, and they sit in two- and three-stage evolution lines.

The type chart is our own: twelve types - Ember, Tide, Verdant, Stone, Gale, Spark, Frost, Shade, Radiance, Iron, Wild and Mind. Twelve is enough for a rich set of strengths and weaknesses, and few enough to actually learn.

Every creature carries the modern six statistics - health, attack, defence, special attack, special defence and speed - plus hidden individual values, a nature, and training values earned in battle. Two creatures of the same species are never quite the same.

THE BATTLE SYSTEM

Battles are turn-based, one creature out at a time. The depth comes from how many systems interlock:

- Moves with power, accuracy, limited uses, priority, a physical or special split, a type, and often a secondary effect.
- Five status conditions of our own - Scorch, Blight, Static, Slumber and Chill. Each behaves differently, and they do not all stack.
- Statistics that can be raised or lowered six steps either way.
- Critical hits, damage variance, and type multipliers running from no effect to four times damage.
- Weather that changes damage and interacts with abilities.
- Held items, switching, a party of six, and storage beyond that.
- Catching with tiered balls, odds that depend on the target’s remaining health and status, and a throw-and-wobble you can watch.
- Experience, growth, learning moves on level, and evolution.
- Trainers who spot you across a route and battle for prize money.
- An opponent that switches out of a bad matchup and heals when low, rather than picking moves at random.

PASSIVE ABILITIES

Every species has at least one passive ability that fires on its own: summoning weather on entry, healing a little each turn, raising defence when struck, shrugging off status, or boosting one type of move. Abilities are what turn a battle from rock-paper-scissors into a puzzle, and the game announces each one the moment it triggers, so a player learns them by watching.

THE SIGNATURE IDEA: LINEAGE

Most games in this genre give you a random colour variant you cannot influence. Ours is different, and it is the heart of the design.

Every creature carries a permanent, visible record of where it came from and what it inherited. That record has three parts:

- Heritage traits, which pass down and affect battle. Breeding combines the parents' traits under clear rules, so chaining generations produces combinations that do not exist in the wild.
- Marks - visible patterns and colours that show ancestry. Because Marks are heritable, you can breed toward the look you want instead of hoping for it. That turns a lottery into a project.
- Origin - the wild area it came from, or the player whose line it descends from, shown as a small family tree on the creature's card.

This changes what trading means. You are not swapping a stat block; you are swapping a history. It also gives the game an engine for endless variety at no art cost, which is the one place a small team can genuinely out-produce a large one.

THE DRIFT

Released creatures do not simply vanish. They drift into other players' worlds with their lineage attached, so you can meet someone else's bloodline in your own grass. Breeding, releasing, trading and exploring become one loop.

CO-OP

Two players can share a battle. That is rare in this genre, and it is a deliberate differentiator. Multiplayer is always an enhancement and never a dependency: if the connection is down, the game still starts, plays and saves on its own.

THE LOOK

The target is HD-2D - hand-drawn pixel creatures standing in a three-dimensional world, with a shallow depth of field that makes the scene look like a small diorama, plus real lighting, glow and drifting particles. It is exactly what 'a Game Boy game, remade' means today.

It is also a rendering layer rather than a different game: the world stays a grid of tiles underneath, so the ambitious part cannot break the part that works. It is planned as a deliberate late stage, with a graphics setting that falls back to flat, crisp pixel art if a device struggles.

HOW IT IS STRUCTURED

Chapter One is a complete game of roughly ten to twelve hours - four badge challenges, about twenty areas, thirty-six creatures - with its own beginning, middle and ending, and threads left open on purpose. Later chapters extend the story, the region and the systems. Every chapter ends with something finished, so stopping is never a loss.

TWO VERSIONS

The game ships as Dawn and Dusk. Most creatures appear in both; each version has a handful of exclusives. That gives trading a real purpose, and gives the multiplayer room a reason to exist beyond battling.

DIFFICULTY AND TONE

Two settings: Easy and Standard. Easy softens damage, is more forgiving on accuracy, avoids early difficulty spikes and lets you retry a lost battle. Standard is the intended experience and is a real game, not a walkover.

The tone is an adventure with genuine twists and turns, carried with humour - real stakes and real surprises, never grim.

SAVES

Three save slots, each a separate game with its own trainer, playtime, badges and collection. Progress saves automatically when you change area and after battles. Saves are versioned so an update never wipes progress, and a save can be exported as a code to move between devices.

THE SHAPE OF THE STORY

A young trainer leaves a coastal village, chooses a first creature, and sets out to earn four badges across Rivenmoor. A rival appears at milestones, always a step ahead. An outfit is working a plan of its own that runs underneath the badge hunt and only becomes clear later. The chapter ends at the league tower, with the immediate story resolved and larger questions deliberately left open.

WHERE IT IS TODAY

The foundation is built and playable: the overworld, wild encounters, the full turn-based battle engine, catching, experience, evolution, party management, creature identity and abilities. Work is now on the world itself - non-player characters, dialogue, trainers, and the second town. Everything described above that is not yet built is planned, not promised.